

THE OMIC ART PRIZE 2026

Rules & Regulations — Shared Ground

1. Theme

Shared Ground explores the UAE as a space shaped by exchange between people, cultures, experiences, and perspectives. The competition invites artists to reflect on what we bring to the place we call home, what we receive from it, and how these exchanges shape both the individual and the shared environment.

2. Dates

- Open Call Announcement: 24 September 2026
- Submission Deadline: 20 October 2026, 11:59 PM (UAE time)
- Selected artworks must be available for the jury's final assessment, delivery, exhibition, and collection at OMIC.

3. Eligibility

- Open to artists aged 18 and above.
- Applicants must be residents of the UAE.
- Artists of any nationality are welcome to apply.

Proof of age and UAE residency (e.g. Emirates ID or visa page) will be requested from shortlisted artists only, as part of confirming their place in the exhibition.

4. Eligible Media

- Painting
- Sculpture
- Installation

5. Artwork Requirements

- Each artist may submit one artwork only.
- The artwork must be an original work created by the applicant.
- The artwork must not have been previously exhibited publicly.
- The artwork must not have previously won an award in another art competition.
- There is no size limitation, though artists should consider practical handling and installation at the venue.

- Selected artworks must be available for exhibition at OMIC.

6. Submission Requirements

Applicants must prepare and submit the following:

- Artwork title
- Medium / materials
- Dimensions
- Year of completion
- High-resolution artwork image(s)
- Artist statement (maximum 150 words)
- Short artist biography
- Contact and residency information

7. Selection Process

All eligible submissions will be reviewed by the jury. Selected artworks will be shortlisted for exhibition at OMIC and considered for the OMIC Art Prize. The jury's decisions are final and not subject to appeal.

8. Awards

Total Prize Pool: AED 15,000

- 1st Prize — AED 10,000 + OMIC Emblem
- 2nd Prize — AED 3,000
- 3rd Prize — AED 2,000

9. Sale of Shortlisted Artworks & Commission

Artworks selected for the Shortlisted Artists Exhibition will be available for sale during the exhibition period, unless the artist chooses otherwise. If a shortlisted artwork is sold through OMIC during the exhibition, OMIC will retain a 35% commission on the final sale price, with the remaining 65% paid to the artist.

Artists are not required to provide a sale price at the time of submission. The final price will be confirmed directly with OMIC prior to the exhibition opening.

10. Rights & Usage

Copyright of each artwork remains with the artist at all times. By submitting an entry,

the artist grants OMIC the right to photograph, reproduce, and use images of the submitted and/or exhibited artwork for promotional, editorial, and archival purposes (including but not limited to social media, press, and the OMIC website), with credit given to the artist.

11. Handling, Delivery & Liability

Unless otherwise agreed with OMIC in advance, artists are responsible for delivering their artwork to OMIC ahead of the exhibition and collecting it at the close of the exhibition. OMIC will exercise reasonable care in the handling, storage, and display of all artworks while on its premises; however, artists bear responsibility for any damage or loss to their artwork, whether occurring in transit, during the exhibition, or during collection. OMIC does not provide insurance coverage for submitted or exhibited works, and artists are encouraged to arrange their own coverage if desired.

12. Disqualification

OMIC reserves the right to disqualify a submission, at any stage, if:

- The delivered artwork does not match the images or description submitted.
- The artwork is found to have been previously exhibited publicly or awarded elsewhere.
- The applicant provides false or incomplete information.
- The applicant does not meet the eligibility criteria in Section 3.

13. General Conditions

- OMIC reserves the right to amend these Rules & Regulations, the Important Dates, or the Prize structure at its discretion, with notice provided to applicants where possible.
- Submission of an entry constitutes full acceptance of these Rules & Regulations, including Section 9 on sales and commission.